# *The race is breaking late toward Democrats*

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## 【メール原文】

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The race is breaking late toward Democrats. Yesterday’s New York Times/Siena College polls are the latest indication that Democrats are increasing their advantage in the final days of the midterm campaign, pointing to a more-than-51-seat majority in the Senate.

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The Times/Siena polls are simply blockbuster for Democrats: They lead by 11 in Michigan, seven in Texas, six in Maine, and five in Ohio and Kansas. Alaska and Iowa are essentially tied, but if the other races break as the poll expects, those would just be icing on the cake of an already-52-seat Democratic majority.
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Other polls are also moving in this direction. Democrats’ vote share in the generic congressional ballot has surged to 51.4%, per Nate Silver, and Democrats have also gained substantially in late polling in Maine, Texas, and Kansas. Ohio and Alaska haven’t moved as much late in the campaign, but Democrats still lead there.
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This adds up to Democrats probably winning at least a 52-seat majority, via North Carolina, Maine, Texas, Ohio, and Kansas. An even larger majority—one likely robust through the next presidential cycle-is absolutely in sight if they can grab Alaska, Iowa, or possibly South Carolina as well. We continue to see Democrats as Senate favorites, at 65% odds (see Late polling surge boosts Democratic odds in Senate , 30 October 2026).

Stevens’s endorsement of Republican is too late to matter in Michigan. Rep. Haley Stevens’s (D-MI) stunning endorsement of Republican Mike Rogers over Democratic Senate candidate Abdul El-Sayed probably won’t make a difference to Democrats’ already-strong chances of holding the state.

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Unlike just after the divisive August primary, El-Sayed now holds a fairly comfortable lead of around five points over Rogers. That is smaller than it should be, given the ten-point swing in the national environment from 2024, but it's enough to see him to victory.

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If Stevens' defection had come earlier in the campaign, it could have seriously disrupted El-Sayed's bid. But with him now having consolidated Democratic support, and with one in four registered Michigan voters already having voted, there's little room left for a November surprise to shift the race.

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The more important implication is for 2028: The intra-Democratic feud over Israel could be a preview of dynamics concerning Israel in the 2028 Democratic primary, especially if progressives—emboldened by El-Sayed's victory in a state that has twice voted for President Donald Trump—push harder against the remaining pro-Israel voices in the party. That could lead to ugly fights that do disrupt Democratic unity.

Long Alaska ranked-choice process could create room for a legal fight. If no candidate in Alaska tomorrow night receives over 50% of the vote, the race goes to a protracted ranked-choice process that would likely take just over two weeks to run, based on recent precedent in the state.

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While tabulating the rounds is straightforward, the state needs to wait for all military and overseas ballots before it can calculate the instant-runoff results. That typically induces a lengthy delay as ballots trickle in.

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Even if neither candidate wins an outright first-round majority, the first-round winner—assuming they win at least 45% of the vote—is very likely to be the ranked-choice winner as well. The first-round winner has won every ranked-choice statewide election in Alaska history. In Maine, the other ranked-choice state, only once has the ranked-choice process lead to a victory for a federal or gubernatorial candidate who trailed in the first round.

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The risk with the Alaska ranked-choice process is twofold.

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First, if Alaska is the decisive state—i.e. if Senate control is 50-49 toward Democrats with the Alaska result outstanding—Senate control likely won't be decided until mid-November.

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Second, the sheer length of the ranked-choice process would give the White House time to mount a second try—after its first was thrown out of court yesterday—at nullifying the election results on the grounds that Democrat Mary Peltola's campaign illegally deceived voters by allegedly recruiting a spoiler candidate with the same name as the Republican incumbent. We doubt that attempt would succeed, but it could induce a few weeks of post-election uncertainty.

Quote of the Day

"I guess I'll become Mr. Veto. And then at some point, we'll probably make deals. That's what's happened, this wouldn't be the first time." - President Trump in an appearance on Pod Force One, responding to the question of how he will react if Republicans lose majorities in both chambers of Congress. President Trump's statement aligns with our view that, while Trump will rely more heavily on executive power after the midterms, there will be some space available for cooperation with Democrats,

particularly surrounding government funding; a deal in which Democrats exchange higher defense spending for delays in cuts to welfare spending is a distinct possibility post-midterms.

On the Radar

3 November: National midterm elections

9 November: Congress returns from recess

18-19 November: APEC leaders meeting in China

11 December: Government funding runs out

14-15 December: G20 summit in Florida

10 January: US-China tariff truce expires

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